

Chapter 3 — Assessment, Rubrics and Quizzes

40 prompts

A good question does more than sort right from wrong — it tells you **what** the student misunderstood. That is the idea running through this whole chapter: distractors that mean something, rubrics a student can act on, and checks that separate real understanding from having copied the method.

WHAT'S IN HERE

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WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Check the maths and the facts yourself. This is the chapter where an unverified error reaches a student's grade. The model will produce a wrong answer key with complete confidence.

Ask what each wrong option reveals. That turns marking into diagnosis and costs you nothing extra.

Single-point rubrics — one column describing proficient — are faster to write and far faster to mark than a full grid. Several prompts here use them.

QUIZZES AND TESTS

AS-001 Create a balanced classroom assessment

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

An end-of-unit test that covers the unit rather than the last two lessons.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create an assessment on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], to be sat in [MINUTES] minutes.

What was taught: [LIST THE OBJECTIVES OR LESSONS]

Balance it: roughly 40% recall and procedure, 40% application, 20% reasoning. Do not let the last thing taught dominate simply because it is freshest.

Give me:

- The paper as students receive it, with marks shown per question
- The full answer key with working
- A blueprint table: each question against which objective it tests
- Any objective the paper never assesses
- The two questions I mark first to learn the most
- An honest estimate of how long a middling student needs, versus the time given

Check every calculation and factual claim. Flag anything you are unsure of rather than presenting it as verified.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Work the whole key yourself before printing.
- Does the blueprint match what you actually taught?
- Sit the paper against a clock. Papers always run long.

AS-005 Build a short quiz across recall, application and reasoning

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Ten minutes, and you want to know more than whether they revised.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a [MINUTES]-minute quiz on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Three sections, clearly different in what they demand:

- Recall: can they retrieve it
- Application: can they use it in a familiar context
- Reasoning: can they explain, justify, or spot where it does not apply

A student who revised by memorising should do well in the first section and struggle in the third. That contrast is the point.

Give me the quiz, the answer key, and one line per section on what a strong or weak performance there tells me.

Keep it to one side of paper.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a memoriser pass the reasoning section? Redesign if so.
- Does it fit on one side at a readable size?

AS-006 Write diagnostic multiple-choice questions with purposeful distractors

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Multiple choice where the wrong answers do the teaching.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write [NUMBER] multiple-choice questions on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Every wrong option must be a specific misconception a real student holds. No filler options, nothing obviously absurd, and no "all of the above".

For each question give me:

- The stem and four options
- The correct answer
- For each wrong option, the exact thinking that leads there
- Whether a student holding that misconception could reach the right answer by elimination – if yes, fix the question

Then tell me which two questions would be most worth putting on the board for a whole-class discussion, and what I would ask about them.

If you cannot name the thinking behind an option, do not include it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you name the thinking behind every wrong option?
- Could a confused student eliminate their way to the answer?

AS-007 Create a constructed-response assessment with a scoring guide

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Extended answers, marked consistently, without three hours of agonising.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create [NUMBER] constructed-response questions on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

For each question give me:

- The question, with the command word doing real work
- What a full-credit response contains, as a list of the things I look for
- A response that has the knowledge but not the structure
- A response that has the structure but thin content
- The scoring guide: what earns each mark, in language I could defend to a parent

Do not award marks for length, neatness, or restating the question. If a criterion cannot be pointed at in the writing, take it out.

Then tell me the fastest order to mark these in, and why.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could two teachers apply this guide and agree?
- Is anything being marked that is not the learning?

AS-008 Design a pre-assessment that separates prerequisite and grade-level skills

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before a unit, to find out what is actually missing.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a [MINUTES]-minute pre-assessment before a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit on [TOPIC].

Two clearly separated parts:

- Prerequisites: the earlier skills this unit assumes
- Grade-level: a small sample of what the unit will teach, so I can see who already knows some of it

Give me:

- Both parts and the answer key
- What each prerequisite item tells me if it is missed
- How to read the four combinations: strong or weak on prerequisites, crossed with strong or weak on grade-level content
- What I do differently for each combination

Students should not be able to tell which part is which from looking at it. Do not make the prerequisite section feel like a test of last year.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the prerequisites genuinely required by this unit?
- Would a student feel judged on last year's teaching?

AS-009 Build a cumulative assessment without over-weighting recent lessons

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A term test, where the first half of term deserves to appear.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a cumulative assessment for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] covering:

[LIST THE TOPICS, WITH ROUGHLY WHEN EACH WAS TAUGHT]

Weight the paper by how much the learning matters, not by how recently it was taught. Tell me the weighting you chose and why.

Give me:

- The paper and full answer key
- A table showing marks per topic against teaching time and importance
- Which older topic students will have forgotten most, and one question that distinguishes forgotten from never learned
- Where topics are combined in a single question, so the paper tests connections rather than isolated recall

Total time: [MINUTES]. Say if the coverage cannot fit honestly.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with the weighting it chose?
- Is any older topic represented by only one question it could fluke?

AS-010 Adapt an assessment for a shorter testing period

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The period got cut and the test still has to happen.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Cut this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] assessment from [ORIGINAL] to [NEW] minutes.

Do not simply delete the last questions. Decide what the assessment is really for and protect the coverage.

Tell me:

- What you cut and what evidence is lost
- Any objective now untested, so I know what I am no longer measuring
- Where two questions can merge into one that tests both
- The revised paper and key
- Whether the shortened version still supports the decision I need to make

If the cut leaves the assessment unable to do its job, say so and tell me what to do instead.

ASSESSMENT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are you comfortable with the objectives it dropped?
- Does the merged question actually test both things?

AS-011 Create parallel assessment forms with equivalent demand

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Two versions, and neither class should be able to claim theirs was harder.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Create two parallel forms of an assessment on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Each question on Form B must match its counterpart on Form A in what it tests and in difficulty – not just have different numbers.

Give me:

- Both forms, question by question, side by side
- Both answer keys
- For each pair, a note on why the difficulty is genuinely equivalent
- Any pair where you are not confident they match, flagged honestly
- Which pair is most at risk of drifting harder or easier

Do not change the numbers in a way that changes the method needed. If a substitution makes one version harder, say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Work both keys. Substitutions often change the method needed.
- Do you agree the flagged pair is the risky one?

AS-012 Audit a test for alignment, ambiguity and answer-key errors

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before thirty students sit it and one of them is right and marked wrong.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] assessment against its objectives.

For each question tell me:

- Which objective it tests, or that it tests none
- Whether a correct answer proves the objective
- Any wording open to a second reading, quoted exactly
- Whether the reading demand exceeds the subject demand
- Whether the answer key is correct – check every one, show your working

Then tell me:

- The question most likely to be challenged by a student, and whether they would be right
- Any objective the paper never tests
- The single change that would most improve the paper

OBJECTIVES: [PASTE THEM]

ASSESSMENT AND KEY: [PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify every key error it claims, yourself. It can be wrong about being right.
- Would you concede the challengeable question?

AS-013 Turn a supplied objective list into a complete assessment blueprint

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Planning what to assess before writing a single question.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build an assessment blueprint for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] from these objectives:

[PASTE THE OBJECTIVES]

Total time: [MINUTES]. Total marks: [NUMBER].

Give me a table with, for each objective:

- Marks allocated, and the reason for that weighting
- The type of question that suits it – some objectives cannot be tested by multiple choice, and you should say which
- How many questions
- The cognitive level being targeted

Then tell me:

- Which objective is hardest to assess in writing, and the closest workable proxy
- Any objective I should assess another way instead
- Whether the marks and the time are consistent with each other

Do not write the questions yet. This is the plan.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the weighting match what you actually value?
- Is the "assess another way" suggestion practical for you?

AS-003 Build a student-readable analytic rubric

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A rubric students read before they start, not after they are marked.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build an analytic rubric for [TASK] in [GRADE] [SUBJECT], assessing [OBJECTIVE].

Write every descriptor for the student, in words a [GRADE] student uses.

Requirements:

- 4-5 criteria maximum, each about the learning
- Four levels, each described by what is present rather than what is missing
- No word that requires my judgement of effort, attitude or neatness
- Nothing that penalises the same weakness in two criteria

Give me the rubric, plus one sentence per criterion a student could use to self-check before submitting.

Then tell me which criterion two teachers would be most likely to score differently, and how to tighten it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student read this and know what to do?
- Is the same weakness costing marks twice anywhere?

FORMATIVE CHECKS AND EXIT TICKETS

AS-002 Create hinge questions for live teaching

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The moment mid-lesson when you decide whether to move on.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write [NUMBER] hinge questions for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC], to use at the point where I decide whether to continue.

Each must be answerable in under a minute, by the whole class at once.

For each give me:

- The question and its options
- The correct answer
- What each wrong option means the student is thinking
- What I do if most of the class chooses each option – a specific next move, not "review the concept"

A student holding a misconception must not be able to reach the right answer by guessing or eliminating. If that is possible, rewrite the question.

Do not give me a mastery percentage. Describe what the responses show; the decision is mine.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is each next move concrete enough to do immediately?
- Could a confused student guess right?

AS-014 Build a five-minute check for understanding during instruction

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Halfway through, before you build anything else on top.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a 5-minute check to run midway through a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC].

It must be quick to give, quick to read across a room, and tell me something I can act on in the same lesson.

Give me:

- The check itself
- How every student responds, so I am not sampling the confident
- What I look for as I scan the room, in one sentence
- Three things I might see, and the immediate next move for each
- How long it honestly takes including handing anything out

If the check needs more than five minutes to be useful, say so and tell me what a five-minute version can and cannot tell me.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you genuinely read thirty responses at a glance?
- Is each next move something you can do in the same lesson?

AS-015 Write an exit ticket that distinguishes three levels of understanding

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three piles by the time you reach the staffroom.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write an exit ticket for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [OBJECTIVE].

Design it so responses sort into three visibly different groups in under five minutes of looking.

Give me:

- The question, answerable in three minutes
- A model secure response
- A realistic developing response – right idea, incomplete
- A realistic not-yet response – the most common wrong route
- The single feature I look for to sort each pile fast
- What I do tomorrow with each group

No marks and no percentages. I am sorting, not scoring.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the three sample responses realistically distinct?
- Is the sorting feature visible without reading every word?

AS-016 Create a misconception poll with actionable response options

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A show of hands that actually tells you something.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a quick poll on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] that I can run with a show of hands, fingers, or coloured cards.

Give me:

- The question, said aloud in under 20 seconds
- Four options, each corresponding to a distinct way of thinking
- What a room split between options A and C tells me, versus a room split between A and B
- The follow-up question I ask a student who chose each option, without revealing whether they were right
- What I do if the room is evenly split four ways

Students must not be able to read the right answer off my face or off which option I said last.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the follow-up questions avoid giving the answer away?
- Would students be honest, or copy the hands going up first?

AS-017 Design a show-me task using mini-whiteboards or paper

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Every student answers, and you see all of it at once.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a show-me task on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] using mini-whiteboards or scrap paper.

Give me:

- The prompt, short enough that the answer fits on a board and is readable across a room
- The signal routine, in my words, so everyone reveals at the same moment
- What a correct board looks like at a glance
- Three wrong boards I should expect, and what each means
- Exactly what I say when I see a wrong board – no shaming, no singling out
- The follow-up prompt for the whole class based on what I see

Answers must be short. If the task needs a paragraph, it is the wrong task for this format – say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the answer readable from four metres away?
- Would your response to a wrong board embarrass anyone?

AS-019 Create a transfer question that reveals reasoning rather than recall

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They can do the board examples. You want to know what that is worth.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a transfer question on [TOPIC] for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] that cannot be answered by copying the pattern from today's examples.

Today's examples were: [DESCRIBE OR PASTE THEM]

The question must need the same thinking in a different shape – a new context, or the unknown in a different place.

Give me:

- The question and the answer
- Exactly what a pattern-copier will write, and why it fails
- One feedback sentence for that student aimed at the thinking, not the answer
- Whether the question is still fair – solvable from today's lesson alone

It must not require anything I have not taught. Tell me if it does.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is it a different shape, or the same question with new numbers?
- Is everything needed to answer it actually taught?

AS-020 Audit a formative check for speed, reading load and decision usefulness

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The check took ten minutes and told you nothing.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] formative check.

Tell me:

- How long it honestly takes to give and to read, versus what I assumed
- Whether a weak reader who understood the content would still get it wrong
- What decision the results actually let me make, stated plainly
- Whether any student can complete it without revealing what they understand
- Whether it samples the whole class or only those who volunteer

Then tell me the smallest change that would make the results more useful, and whether this check is worth the lesson time at all.

CHECK:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- If it says the check is not worth the time, do you agree?
- Is the reading demand fair for your weakest reader?

AS-018 Turn anonymous responses into a next-day formative check

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Yesterday's responses are in front of you and tomorrow needs planning.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Yesterday's [GRADE] [SUBJECT] check on [TOPIC] produced these patterns:

[DESCRIBE WHAT YOU SAW – how many did what. No names.]

Design tomorrow's opening check that follows up on this.

Give me:

- A 5-minute check aimed at the main pattern
- What students who were already secure do during it, that is not waiting
- One sentence framing it that does not reveal who got what wrong
- What I compare against yesterday to know whether anything changed
- What it means if the same pattern appears again

Do not build anything that lets the class work out who was in which group.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could students decode who struggled? Redesign if so.
- Do the secure students have something real to do?

RUBRICS

AS-021 Create observable descriptors for four performance levels

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Four levels that mean something more than "good, quite good, not good".

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write four-level descriptors for this criterion in [GRADE] [SUBJECT]:

[CRITERION]

Task: [TASK]

Each level must describe what is present in the work, not what is missing. "Does not include evidence" is a marking note; "Uses one piece of evidence, stated without explanation" is a descriptor.

Give me:

- The four descriptors
- A concrete example of work at each level
- The boundary between levels 2 and 3, stated as the one thing that changes
- Any word in my criterion too vague to observe, and its replacement

Do not use "sometimes", "usually", "adequate", "appropriate" or "effective" without saying exactly what would count.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the 2/3 boundary something you could defend to a parent?
- Any vague words left?

AS-022 Turn an objective and task into aligned rubric criteria

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The rubric should measure the objective, not the artefact.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Derive rubric criteria for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task.

Objective: [OBJECTIVE]

Task: [TASK]

Give me:

- 3-5 criteria that come from the objective, not from the format of the task
- For each, the evidence in the work that shows it
- Anything the task demands that the objective does not – presentation, handwriting, creativity – and whether it belongs in the rubric at all
- Anything in the objective the task cannot evidence

If the task cannot evidence the objective, say so plainly and tell me the smallest change to the task that would fix it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are you marking the learning or the artefact?
- Do you agree with what it said the task cannot evidence?

AS-023 Build a single-point rubric with feedback space

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Faster to write, far faster to mark, and the feedback is specific.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a single-point rubric for [TASK] in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Format: one centre column stating what proficient looks like for each criterion,
with blank columns either side for what is not yet there and what goes beyond.

Give me:

- 4-5 criteria maximum, in student-readable language
- The proficient descriptor for each
- Three reusable feedback sentences per criterion for the not-yet column
- Three for the beyond column
- The one criterion I should look at first when marking

The blank columns stay blank in the template – I fill them per student. Do not pre-fill them with generic levels.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the reusable sentences specific enough to be worth reusing?
- Could a student self-assess against the centre column?

AS-024 Create a rubric for collaborative work with individual evidence

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A group mark that does not hide who learned what.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a rubric for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] group task assessing [OBJECTIVE].

Two separate parts:

- Group criteria: what the group produced together
- Individual criteria: what each student personally demonstrated

The individual part must be markable from something the student produced alone.

It cannot rest on my impression of who talked most.

Give me:

- Both sets of criteria with descriptors
- What each student produces that carries the individual evidence
- How the two parts combine, and whether they should
- What I do when the group product is strong and one student's evidence is thin

Do not include peer-rating scores as a criterion. Tell me why if you disagree.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you mark the individual part without relying on memory?
- Is a quiet student penalised anywhere here?

AS-025 Rewrite vague rubric words as observable evidence

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Your rubric says "shows good understanding" and nobody knows what that means.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] rubric so every descriptor points at something observable in the work.

For each vague phrase:

- Quote it
- Say what it probably means here
- Replace it with what I would actually see

Pay particular attention to: good, appropriate, effective, adequate, clear, thorough, engaging, creative, sometimes, mostly, and consistently.

Then flag any criterion that is really about effort, personality or compliance rather than learning, and tell me whether it belongs in the rubric.

RUBRIC:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could two teachers now agree on a borderline piece?
- Are you willing to drop the effort criteria it flagged?

AS-026 Calibrate a rubric using fictional work samples

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Testing the rubric before it meets real work.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write fictional student work samples to test this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] rubric.

Give me four invented pieces – use "Student A", "Student B" and so on, and make

clear they are fabricated for calibration:

- One clearly at the top level
- One clearly at the bottom
- Two genuinely borderline between adjacent levels

For each: the sample, the score each criterion should receive, and the reasoning.

Then tell me:

- Which criterion was hardest to apply to the borderline samples
- What that reveals about the rubric's wording
- The change that would make the borderline cases decidable

Do not use real student work and do not present these as real.

RUBRIC:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you score the borderline samples the same way it did?
- Is the wording problem it found a real one?

AS-027 Audit a rubric for double penalties, bias and irrelevant criteria

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before it decides anyone's grade.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] rubric.

Tell me:

- Where the same weakness costs marks under two criteria
- Any criterion that measures something other than the learning – presentation, handwriting, resources available at home, confidence in speaking
- Anywhere a student with weaker language would score lower despite equal understanding
- Any descriptor requiring me to judge effort or attitude
- Where two adjacent levels are not actually distinguishable

Then give me the single change that would make it fairest, and say which criterion I could delete entirely without losing anything.

RUBRIC:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the double penalty it found real? That one matters most.
- Would you defend every remaining criterion to a parent?

DIAGNOSIS AND MISCONCEPTIONS

AS-004 Diagnose errors from anonymous work

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A pile of wrong answers, and you want the reason rather than the count.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here are the errors from a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task on [TOPIC]. No names.

[DESCRIBE OR LIST WHAT STUDENTS ACTUALLY WROTE]

For each distinct error tell me:

- The thinking that produces it – the reasoning, not the fault
- Whether it is a slip, a gap in prerequisite knowledge, or a wrong idea about the concept
- Roughly how many students it affects, from what I described
- Whether anything in a standard explanation of this topic encourages it

Then rank the errors by how much they will block what comes next, and tell me which one to address first.

Where my description is not enough to tell two causes apart, say so and tell me what to look for rather than guessing.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the explanation of their thinking match what you saw?
- Where it said it could not tell, do you know how to find out?

AS-028 Code anonymous responses by misconception rather than score alone

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Turning a stack of scripts into groups you can teach.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Help me sort a set of [GRADE] [SUBJECT] responses on [TOPIC] by what students were thinking, not by how many marks they got.

The question was: [PASTE IT]

The responses I am seeing: [DESCRIBE THE RANGE, no names]

Give me:

- 3-5 codes, each a distinct way of thinking
- The observable marker for each – what I look for to assign a script in seconds
- Which codes can appear in the same script
- Two scripts that would score the same but belong in different codes, and why that distinction matters more than the score

Keep the codes few enough to hold in my head while marking.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you assign a script in a few seconds using these markers?
- Is the same-score-different-code example one you recognise?

AS-030 Distinguish a careless slip from a conceptual misunderstanding

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Reteaching a concept someone already understands wastes everyone's time.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] error on [TOPIC] – [DESCRIBE IT] – help me tell whether it is a slip or a misunderstanding.

Give me:

- What the error looks like when it is a slip
- What it looks like when the concept is wrong
- The signs that separate them in the written work itself
- One question I could ask the student that settles it in thirty seconds, without leading them to the answer
- What I do in each case

If my description does not contain enough to distinguish them, say so and tell me what else to look at in the work.

Do not assume it is a slip because the student is usually strong.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the thirty-second question avoid leading them?
- Are the written signs ones you can actually see in the work?

AS-029 Build flexible reteaching groups from response patterns

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three groups, one lesson, and no permanent labels.

COPY THIS PROMPT

From these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] response patterns on [TOPIC], build reteaching groups.

Pattern A: [DESCRIBE] – about [NUMBER] students

Pattern B: [DESCRIBE] – about [NUMBER] students

Pattern C: [DESCRIBE] – about [NUMBER] students

Give me:

- What each group actually needs, in one line
- Which group I sit with first, and why
- What the other two do that is genuinely useful without me
- How groups are formed without the class reading them as ability
- The check at the end that tells me whether to regroup or move on

These groups exist for one lesson. Tell me what would make me dissolve them.

No student names anywhere in this.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could the class decode the grouping? Change it if so.
- Does the group you leave alone have real work?

AS-031 Create targeted mini-tasks for three misconception groups

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Fifteen minutes, three different problems, one room.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write three 15-minute mini-tasks, one for each of these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] misconceptions on [TOPIC]:

1. [DESCRIBE]
2. [DESCRIBE]
3. [DESCRIBE]

Each task must confront the specific wrong idea, not re-explain the correct method more slowly.

For each give me:

- The task
- The moment in it where the misconception visibly fails
- The answer
- What a student who has genuinely shifted will write differently
- What to do if they complete it and the misconception survives

All three should be startable without me explaining them, since I can only be in one place.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does each task genuinely break the wrong idea?
- Can students start all three without you?

AS-032 Plan a reassessment that shows whether reteaching worked

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You retaught it. Now you need to know if that changed anything.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a reassessment after reteaching [TOPIC] to [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

The original problem was: [DESCRIBE THE MISCONCEPTION OR GAP]

Give me:

- Questions that test the same thing in a different form, so a student who memorised my reteaching examples cannot pass on recall
- One question where the old misconception would still show, if it survived
- The answer key
- What it means if results improve on the familiar form but not the new one
- How soon after reteaching to run this, and why

Do not reuse the original questions. Tell me if the gap between the two assessments is too short for the result to mean anything.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student pass by remembering your reteaching examples?
- Is the timing gap it recommended workable for you?

ANSWER KEYS AND FEEDBACK

AS-033 Create a complete worked answer key from verified questions

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A key you could hand to a cover teacher or a student.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a full worked answer key for the [GRADE] [SUBJECT] questions below.

For each question:

- The answer
- The working, step by step, with the reasoning at each step
- The most likely wrong answer and where it comes from
- Where partial credit is defensible, and for what

Check every calculation. Where you are not fully certain of a factual claim or a result, say so explicitly rather than presenting it as verified – I would rather have a flag than a confident error.

At the end, list any question where the wording allows a second defensible answer.

QUESTIONS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Work every answer yourself. This is the highest-risk prompt in the chapter.
- Take the flagged uncertain items seriously.

AS-034 Write actionable feedback matched to common response patterns

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Thirty pieces of feedback that are specific without writing thirty essays.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] task on [TOPIC], write reusable feedback matched to the response patterns I am seeing:

[DESCRIBE THE PATTERNS, no names]

For each pattern give me:

- One or two sentences of feedback naming what the student did and the single next step
- Written to the student, in [GRADE]-appropriate language
- A blank [SPECIFIC EXAMPLE] I fill from their actual work

Rules: no praise sandwiches, nothing about effort or attitude, one next step only, and never a comment a student cannot act on by themselves.

Then tell me which pattern needs a conversation rather than written feedback.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could the student act on this alone?
- Is anything here about effort rather than the work?

AS-035 Audit an answer key for mathematical, factual and scoring errors

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before you mark thirty papers against it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Check this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] answer key against its questions.

For each item:

- Recompute or re-derive the answer independently and show your working
- Say whether the key is right, wrong, or arguable
- Where wrong, give the correct answer and where the key went astray
- Where arguable, say what other answer a student could defend

Then tell me:

- Any question where the mark allocation does not match the work required
- Any place partial credit is unclear, so I would mark inconsistently

Where you cannot verify something independently, say so rather than agreeing with the key by default.

QUESTIONS AND KEY:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify anything it calls an error, yourself. It can be wrong too.
- Decide the arguable answers before you start marking, not during.

AS-036 Create learner-friendly solution explanations without hiding reasoning

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Solutions a student can learn from, rather than copy.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] solutions so a student can learn from them.

For each:

- Show every step, including the ones a teacher does in their head
- Say why each step, not only what
- Name the decision point – where a student has to choose an approach – and what tells them which to choose
- Add one line on what to check at the end

Do not skip steps to be concise, and do not use "clearly", "obviously" or "it follows that". If it were obvious the student would not need the solution.

Keep the language at [GRADE] level.

SOLUTIONS:

[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Any "obviously" left in?
- Would a stuck student get unstuck from this, or just copy it?

STANDARDS-BASED GRADING

AS-037 Map assessment evidence to supplied standards and objectives

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Reporting against standards, from work you already have.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Map this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] assessment to the standards below.

Give me a table showing, for each standard:

- Which questions provide evidence for it
- How strong that evidence is – a single question is thin evidence, say so
- What part of the standard is never evidenced
- Whether a student could score well on those questions without meeting the standard

Then tell me which standards I cannot honestly report on from this assessment, and what additional evidence would be needed.

Use only the standard wording I paste. Do not fill gaps with what a standard like this usually says.

STANDARDS: [PASTE THE EXACT WORDING]

ASSESSMENT: [PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are you reporting on any standard it called thinly evidenced?
- Does the mapping use your standard's real wording?

AS-038 Create a standards-based proficiency scale with observable evidence

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A scale that describes learning rather than counting marks.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a proficiency scale for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] standard:

[PASTE THE EXACT WORDING]

Give me four levels, each describing what the student can do, with:

- An observable description
- An example task a student at that level completes successfully
- The specific thing that changes between each level and the next
- What evidence I would need to place a student there confidently

Do not attach percentages or mark ranges. The levels describe learning, not arithmetic.

Then tell me the level most often assigned too generously, and what to look for to avoid that.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could you place a real student using only these descriptions?
- Is the over-generous level one you recognise in your own marking?

AS-039 Summarize class mastery without averaging unrelated skills

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A single average hides everything that matters.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Summarise where my [GRADE] [SUBJECT] class stands on these standards, from this evidence:

STANDARDS: [LIST THEM]

EVIDENCE: [DESCRIBE PERFORMANCE PER STANDARD – no names]

Report each standard separately. Do not average across standards; a student secure in one and lost in another is not "middling".

Give me:

- A per-standard summary of where the class is
- Which standard the class is weakest on, and whether that is a teaching problem or an assessment problem
- Which standard I have the thinnest evidence for
- What a single overall average would have hidden here

Say plainly where the evidence is too thin to report on at all.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with teaching problem versus assessment problem?
- Are you reporting anything it called too thin?

AS-040 Audit a standards-based grade summary for missing or weak evidence

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before the grades go out and someone asks how you decided.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] standards-based summary.

Tell me:

- Which standards rest on a single piece of evidence
- Where the evidence is all of one type, so I am measuring one format rather than the learning
- Any standard where recent work outweighs everything else without a reason
- Anywhere a behaviour or effort judgement has crept into an academic standard
- Which judgement I would find hardest to defend if a family questioned it

Then tell me the one standard I should gather more evidence on before reporting.

SUMMARY:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could you defend the judgement it flagged as weakest?
- Has effort crept into an academic standard anywhere?